Why AI Cheat Detectors Fail KEY

Name _____

Work with a partner. Compare answers when you finish each problem.

Word bank: false positive predictable short sentences and common words

You can use a word more than once.

1. Human or AI? Circle your vote for each paragraph Mr. Ross reads.

1. H A 2. H A 3. H A 4. H A The class got _____ of 4 right.

2. How detectors guess.

A chatbot picks likely next words, so AI writing is very predictable.

A detector says "AI" when the words are very predictable.

Human writing that is predictable: short sentences and common words,

like many people writing in a second language.

When a detector says "AI" but a person wrote it, that is a false positive.

3. The evidence.

Stanford, 2023: essays by people learning English that detectors called AI	61% on average; 98% by at least one detector

Word bank: careful cheaters honest people who write simply my drafts my notes version history

4. Test the toy detector.

Writing	% common words	It said	Right?
A person: Frederick Douglass, 1845	61%	person	yes
AI, written for this book	94%	AI	yes
AI, told to use rare words	14%	person	no
My own writing			
My writing with 3 rare words			

The detector blames honest people who write simply, and misses careful cheaters.

5. Protect yourself. Three kinds of evidence of my own work:

my drafts version history my notes

6. Talk about it. Our school (should / should not) use AI detectors, because

Answers vary.

Instead of a detector, a teacher could Answers vary. Talk with the student about the work.